

Applied Linear Algebra

Finite-Dimensional Vector Spaces

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- A scalar is a single value, which can be an integer, a real number, or a complex number.
- Scalars are the simplest mathematical objects.

Quiz:

Name a few good examples of scalars.

- A vector is a more structured mathematical object.
- A vector is an ordered sequence of scalars.

$$\mathbf{v} = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

where $\mathbb{R}^n$ is the set of all n-dimensional real vectors.

$$v = (0.35, 0.71, 0.23, 0.8) \in \mathbb{R}^4$$

$$v = (0.35) \in \mathbb{R}^?$$

$$v = (0.35, 0.71) \in \mathbb{R}^?$$

$$v = () \in \mathbb{R}^?$$

Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a $m \times n$ matrix.

The n columns of $\mathbf{A}$ are vectors in $\mathbb{R}^m$.

Example: A matrix with 4 column vectors in $\mathbb{R}^5$

$$\begin{bmatrix} .1 & .2 & .3 & 0.6 \\ .4 & .5 & .6 & 0.12 \\ .7 & .8 & .9 & 0.18 \\ .11 & .12 & .13 & 0.26 \\ .21 & .22 & .23 & 0.33 \end{bmatrix}$$

A vector can be represented as a row or column of scalars.

Row vector

$(0.35, 0.71, 0.23, 0.8)$

Column vector

$\begin{bmatrix} 0.35 \\ 0.71 \\ 0.23 \\ 0.8 \end{bmatrix}$

A *unit vector* is a vector with all elements equal to zero, except one element which is equal to one.

The i -th unit vector (of size n) is the unit vector with i -th element one, and denoted e_i .

$$e_1 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad e_2 = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad e_3 = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

The i -th unit vector (of size n) is the unit vector with i -th element one, and denoted e_i .

$$(e_i)_j = \begin{cases} 1 & i = j \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \quad (1)$$

for $i, j = 1, \dots, n$.

e_i is an n -vector. $(e_i)_j$ is a number, its j -th entry.

A *ones vector* is a vector with all elements equal to one. The n -dimensional ones vector is denoted $\mathbf{1}_n$.

$$\mathbf{1}_3 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{1}_4 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{1}_5 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Properties of Vector Addition

Unit 1

For any n -vectors a , b , and c , the following properties hold:

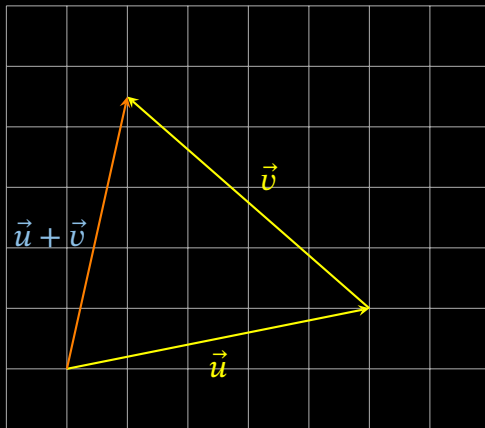
- Vector addition is *commutative*: $a + b = b + a$.
- Vector addition is *associative*: $(a + b) + c = a + (b + c)$. We can therefore write both as $a + b + c$.
- $a + \mathbf{0} = \mathbf{0} + a = a$. Adding the zero vector to a vector has no effect.[†]
- $a - a = \mathbf{0}$. Subtracting a vector from itself gives the zero vector.

Can you think of the geometric interpretation of these properties?

[†] The size of the zero vector follows from the context

Vector Addition

Unit 1



For any $a \in \mathbb{R}^n$, and scalars $\alpha, \beta, \gamma \in \mathbb{R}$, the following properties hold:

- scalar-vector multiplication is *commutative*: $\alpha a = a\alpha$.
- scalar-vector multiplication is *associative*: $(\beta\gamma)a = \beta(\gamma a)$.
- $1 a = a$. Multiplying a vector by the scalar 1 has no effect.
- $0 a = \mathbf{0}$. Multiplying a vector by the scalar 0 gives the zero vector.
- $\beta(a + b) = \beta a + \beta b$. Scalar multiplication distributes over vector addition.
- $(\beta + \gamma)a = \beta a + \gamma a$. The distributive property of scalar-vector multiplication.

A vector space V is a set endowed with a rule for addition and a rule for scalar multiplication

$$+ : V \times V \rightarrow V$$

$$\cdot : \mathbb{R} \times V \rightarrow V$$

such that the following axioms hold for all $u, v, w \in V$ and all scalars $c_1, c_2 \in \mathbb{R}$:

1. $u + v = v + u$
2. $(u + v) + w = u + (v + w)$
3. $v + \mathbf{0} = v$
4. $v + (-v) = \mathbf{0}$ where $-v$ is the unique additive inverse of v
5. $c_1 \cdot (v + w) = c_1 \cdot v + c_1 \cdot w$
6. $(c_1 + c_2) \cdot v = c_1 \cdot v + c_2 \cdot v$
7. $c_1 \cdot (c_2 \cdot v) = (c_1 c_2) \cdot v$
8. $1 \cdot v = v$

Examples of Vector Spaces

Question:

is a 3×2 matrix of $\mathbb{R}$ a vector space?

is a 3×2 matrix with non-negative entries a vector space?

is a $m \times n$ matrix of $\mathbb{R}$ a vector space?

Definition

The space $\mathbb{R}^n$ consists of all column vectors with n components, where each component is a real number.

Quiz

1. Suppose addition in $\mathbb{R}^2$ adds an extra 1 to each component. With scalar multiplication unchanged, which rules are broken?
2. Show that the set of all positive real numbers, with $x + y$ and cx redefined to equal the usual xy and x^c , is a vector space. What is the “zero vector”?

if $a_1, \dots, a_m$ are n -vectors, and $\beta_1, \dots, \beta_m$ are scalars, the n -vector

$$\beta_1 a_1 + \dots + \beta_m a_m$$

is called the *linear combination* of the vectors $a_1, \dots, a_m$.

The scalars $\beta_1, \dots, \beta_m$ are called the *coefficients* of the linear combination.

$$\begin{bmatrix} 8.3 \\ -0.2 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix} = 8.3 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + (-0.2) \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + 10 \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

When the coefficients sum to one, i.e., $\beta_1 + \cdots + \beta_m = 1$, the linear combination is called an *affine combination*.

When the coefficients in an affine combination are nonnegative, it is called a *convex combination*, or a *weighted average*.

Inner Product

Definition (Inner or Dot Product)

The inner product of two n -vectors is defined as the *scalar*

$$a^T b = a_1 b_1 + a_2 b_2 + \dots + a_n b_n,$$

the sum of the products of corresponding entries.

If a , b , and c are vectors of the same size, and γ is a scalar, then the following hold:

1. *Commutativity*: $a^T b = b^T a$ aka *symmetric*
2. *Associativity with scalar multiplication*: $(\gamma a)^T b = \gamma (a^T b)$
3. *Distributivity with vector addition*: $(a + b)^T c = a^T c + b^T c$

- *Unit vector.* $e_i^T a = a_i$
- *Sum.* $1^T a = a_1 + \cdots + a_n$
- *Sum of squares.* $a^T a = a_1^2 + \cdots + a_n^2$

- *Co-occurrence.* $a^T b = a_1 b_1 + \cdots + a_n b_n$ counts the number of times
- *Weighs, features, and scores.* $w^T x = w_1 x_1 + \cdots + w_n x_n$
- *Polynomial evaluation.* $p(x) = a_0 + a_1 x + \cdots + a_n x^n = [1, x, \dots, x^n]^T [a_0, a_1, \dots, a_n]$
- *Probability and expected values.*
 $E[X] = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i p_i = [x_1, \dots, x_n]^T [p_1, \dots, p_n]$

Outer Product

Definition (Outer Product)

The outer product of a m -vector a and an n -vector b is given by ab^T , which is an $m \times n$ matrix

$$ab^T = \begin{bmatrix} a_1b_1 & a_1b_2 & \cdots & a_1b_n \\ a_2b_1 & a_2b_2 & \cdots & a_2b_n \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_mb_1 & a_mb_2 & \cdots & a_mb_n \end{bmatrix},$$

whose entries are all products of the entries of a and the entries of b .

In general, $a^Tb \neq b^Ta$, i.e., it is not *symmetric*

Definition (The Trivial Space)

The space $\mathbb{R}^0$ is the unique zero-dimensional real vector space. It contains exactly one element, the empty vector v :

$$v \in \mathbb{R}^0 \quad \text{where} \quad v = []$$

Definition

A subspace W of a vector space V is a non-empty subset of V that is itself a vector space under the same operations of addition and scalar multiplication defined on V .

1. The zero vector of V is in W .
2. If $u, v \in W$, then $u + v \in W$ (closed under addition).
3. If c is a scalar and $v \in W$, then $cv \in W$ (closed under scalar multiplication).

Consider all vectors in $\mathbb{R}^2$ whose components are positive or zero.

This subset is the first quadrant of the x-y plane.

It is not a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^2$ because it is not closed under scalar multiplication.

For example, if

$$v = [1, 1]$$

is in the first quadrant, then

$$-1 \cdot v = [-1, -1]$$

is not in the first quadrant.

If we include the third quadrant along with the first, scalar multiplication is closed, but the set is still not a subspace because it is not closed under addition.

For example, if

$$u = [1, 2] \quad \text{and} \quad v = [-2, -1]$$

are in the first and third quadrants, then

$$u + v = [-1, 1]$$

is not in the first or third quadrant.

The smallest subspace of $\mathbb{R}^2$ that contains the first quadrant is the entire space $\mathbb{R}^2$.

Math vs. Code



- Textbooks use *column vectors* for single samples.
- PyTorch uses *row vectors* to handle batches.
- Single sample $\mathbf{x}$ is a column vector.
- Forward pass formula:

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{W}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{b}$$

- Dimensions:

$$\begin{matrix} \mathbf{y} & = & \mathbf{W} & \mathbf{x} & + & \mathbf{b} \\ (c \times 1) & & (c \times d) & (d \times 1) & & (c \times 1) \end{matrix}$$

Math vs. Code



- Textbooks use *column vectors* for single samples.
- PyTorch uses *row vectors* to handle batches.
- Batch $\mathbf{X}$ stacks samples as rows.
- PyTorch *nn.Linear* formula:

$$\mathbf{Y} = \mathbf{X}\mathbf{W}^T + \mathbf{B}$$

- Dimensions (N = batch size):

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \mathbf{Y} & = & \mathbf{X} & \mathbf{W}^T & + & \mathbf{B} \\ (N \times c) & & (N \times d) & (d \times c) & & (1 \times c) \end{array}$$

NumPy and PyTorch



The standard convention for data analysis and machine learning is that

- rows represent samples or observations: **axis 0**
- columns represent features or attributes: **axis 1**